

# Mei Zhou

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## PRESENT POSITION

**Dissertation Year Fellow**  
*The University of Hong Kong*

**Expected: Feb 2027**

## EDUCATION

**The University of Hong Kong**  
*Ph.D. in Cognitive Neuroscience*

**Hong Kong SAR**  
*2021–2025*

Dissertation: Probabilistic Memory Prioritization Mechanisms in Statistical Learning

Committees: Shelley Xiuli Tong (Supervisor), Matthew Leonard, Tom Verguts, Yuanwei Yao

**Zhejiang University**  
*B.Sc. in Psychology and Behavioral Sciences*

**Hangzhou, China**  
*2017–2021*

Dissertation: Unconscious Processing of Social Interaction Information

## AWARDS AND GRANTS

The University of Hong Kong Dissertation Year Fellowship (HK\$340,800)

Mar 2026

The University of Hong Kong Research Postgraduate Student Publication Award (HK\$5,000)

Oct 2024

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Statistical learning  
Working memory  
Memory prioritization  
Cognitive neuroscience  
Computational modeling  
Developmental science  
Developmental dyslexia

## PUBLICATIONS

### Peer-Reviewed Articles

1. Tong, S. X., Zhang, P., **Zhou, M.**, & Ziegler, J. (2026). How uncertainty affects children's exploration and exploitation in statistical learning. *Developmental Science*, 29(4), e70235. <https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.70235>  
IF = 4.2; Citations = 0; Q1 in Developmental and Educational Psychology.
2. An, N., **Zhou, M.**, Ziegler, J. C., & Tong, S. X. (2026). The impact of working memory on Chinese word reading: The respective roles of quality and quantity. *Scientific Studies of Reading*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10888438.2026.2659583>

IF = 3.8; Citations = 0; Q1 in Education.

3. **Zhou, M.**, & Tong, S. X. (2025). Statistical learning prioritizes abstract over item-specific representations. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 32, 3264–3275. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-025-02757-8>

IF = 4.2; Citations = 2; Ranked 13/169 (Q1) in Experimental and Cognitive Psychology.

4. **Zhou, M.**, Zhang, P., Mimeau, C., & Tong, S. X. (2024). Unravelling the complex interplay between statistical learning and working memory in Chinese children with and without dyslexia across different ages. *Child Development*, 95(5), e338–e351. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.14121>

IF = 5.0; Citations = 16; Ranked 7/60 (Q1) in Educational Psychology.

5. Fu, Y., **Zhou, M.**, Zhou, J., Shen, M., & Chen, H. (2024). Unconscious prioritization for face-to-face people. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 153(5), 1268–1280. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001556>

IF = 4.5; Citations = 12; Ranked 8/102 (Q1) in Experimental Psychology.

### Manuscripts Under Review

6. **Zhou, M.**, & Tong, S. X. (2026). Temporal dynamics of probability and structure representations during statistical learning. *Manuscript under review*.
7. **Zhou, M.**, & Tong, S. X. (2026). Predictive priority shapes human statistical learning in multi-regularity environments. *Manuscript under review*.
8. Guo, Q., Wang, X., **Zhou, M.**, & Tong, S. X. (2026). Neurophysiological signatures of statistical learning: An EEG meta-analysis. *Manuscript under review*.

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

*Note:* presenter

### Symposium Talks

1. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Sep 2026). “The Dynamic Interplay Between Conditional and Distributional Statistical Learning.” Symposium: “Unravelling the Cognitive Mechanisms of Learning Across the Lifespan.” *The Joint ESCoP-CoPM Meeting 2026*. [Symposium Chair]

### Oral Presentations

2. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Jun 2022). “The Development of Statistical Learning and Working Memory in Chinese Children With and Without Dyslexia.” *The International Conference on Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*.

### Posters

3. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Jun 2026). “Distinct Neural Representations of Probability for Abstract and Item-Specific Information During Statistical Learning.” *The International Conference on Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*.
4. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Dec 2025). “Abstract Over Item-Specific Information: Statistical Learning Optimizes Memory Representation.” *The 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

## TEACHING

Guest Lecture, The University of Hong Kong

Feb 2026

Replication Crisis in Psychological Research

PHIL2140: Philosophy of Social Science

## ADVISING

- Exploring the Mind: Cognitive Science Experimenter Training** Fall 2026  
**Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong**  
Jeffrey Chan, Sabrina Yiu Yiu Choi, Alice Kwan Yin Hung, Angus Tsz Fung Yan, Yui Hin Ng, Hannah Hanxue Wu, Esme Ziyuan Yang
- Speech, Language, and Reading Lab**  
**The University of Hong Kong** 2021-present  
Supervise for over 6 undergraduate and graduate research interns

## WORKSHOPS

- Statistical Tests in Psychological Studies** Aug 2026  
Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong  
Presenter
- Scoring Guide for Torrance Tests of Creativity Thinking** Oct 2023  
Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong  
Organizer and Presenter

## RESEARCH TRAINING

- The University of Hong Kong** 2021-present  
Graduate student  
Supervisor: Prof. Shelley Xiuli Tong
- Zhejiang University** 2020-2021  
Undergraduate student  
Supervisor: Prof. Hui Chen
- Zhejiang University** May 2020  
Undergraduate research assistant  
Supervisor: Prof. Zaifeng Gao  
Project: Human Reliability for Intelligent Manufacturing
- Peking University** December 2019  
Undergraduate research assistant  
Supervisor: Prof. Yang Bai  
Project: Emotional Perception in Workspace Situations

## SKILLS

- Experimental methods:** Behavioral experiments, eye tracking, EEG
- Statistical analysis:** Generalized linear mixed models, Bayesian analysis, ANOVA, factor analysis, item response theory analysis
- EEG analysis:** ERP, time-frequency, representational similarity analysis, phase-amplitude coupling
- Computational modeling:** Bayesian knowledge tracing, hierarchical Bayesian modeling, machine learning
- Programming:** R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX
- Languages:** Chinese (native), English (professional proficiency)

**PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS**

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|---------------------------|--------------|
| Psychonomic Society       | 2024-present |
| Cognitive Science Society | 2025-present |